THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION

PARIS BRANCH

MINI NEWSLETTER
February 2009

Chairman's Report

As Vera Lynn used to sing in the dark days of WWII*: " We'll meet again, don't know where, don't know when"*. This is likely to be the last Newsletter of the Paris Branch from our Clubhouse in rue Boudreau. We have been there since 1928, first as tenants, then as owners since 1953. The Paris Branch did not hold meetings in Paris between 1940-1944, for reasons which escape me now. They preferred to hold them in London, where Général de Gaulle addressed a Branch meeting on one occasion. How far-sighted it was of our predecessors to find and later invest in such central premises. Our Secretary recently unearthed a French newspaper dating from July 1924. It reported on the Olympic Games then in full swing in Paris ("Chariots of Fire"), but on the front page is an article reporting the visit of H.R.H. Edward, The Prince of Wales, to open the Paris Branch new Clubhouse in the boulevard Lannes. In fact the Branch only spent four years there before alighting on the property in the rue Boudreau. For reasons which are well-known we are now obliged to find premises which conform to the Health and Safety norms for occupants who hold public gatherings. As earlier reported, we have accepted the offer of our neighbour, the Maison du Limousin, to purchase our premises and the Notary expects to be in a position to finalize the paperwork for signature in the next week or so. In the meantime we have an agreement with the Maison du Limousin to continue to have access to the premises for our February meetings. In parallel we have been searching for several months now for alternative premises in Central Paris, preferably on the ground floor with easy access for elderly and handicapped members and guests, and, conversely, easy evacuation facilities in the event of an emergency. We have found one such property, situated in the rue des Acacias in the 17e, five minutes walk from the Arc de Triomphe and Ligne A of the R.E.R. Sufficiently impressed, we have made a provisional offer with a number of *clauses suspensives*, and at the time of going to press we understand this offer is acceptable to the vendor. If executed, this acquisition will call for a certain amount of refitting and redecoration, which, according to the estimate received from our architect, we judge to be well within our overall acquisition cost budget. Needless to say, that if all goes according to plan, there will nevertheless most likely be a short interval between leaving rue Boudreau and moving into revamped new premises.

At this juncture I want to record on behalf of your Committee how fortunate we are to have these transactions and searches managed by our steering group comprised of our Treasurer, David Blanchard; our Property Member, Charles Spencer-Bernard; David Bean, our House Manager; and David Tudor Edwards, the Chairman of the original Clubhouse Project Working Party. Thank you all, gentlemen. Naturally all plans for social events have been on hold. The first event in the New Year will in fact be the lunch to which members are kindly invited at a member's flat in the 16e on 2nd March. Details are attached in the Secretary's Letter. In addition, before final evacuation of our premises, we hope to hold an informal cocktail at rue Boudreau at which the possibility of one last chorus of "It's a Long Way to Tipperary" and "Auld Lang Syne" cannot be ruled out ! We shall release the date of this event as soon as our departure date is fixed.

Finally I wanted to report an excellent piece of good news, that despite the gathering global financial gloom, our Poppy Appeal Organizer Mrs Joyce Gilhooley has registered a total of donations for the 2008 Campaign which compares very favourably with our previous record years, and we owe her and her team our warm thanks for a job well done, and with great dedication.

« We will remember them »

SECRETARIES CORNER
JANUARY/FEBRUARY
2009

HAPPY NEW YEAR to you all from the Secretaries Corner.

We hope you have enjoyed the Christmas and New Year holidays and are keeping warm in this rather chilly weather we are experiencing.

As you will see we have enclosed the winners of the Christmas Tombola. Could all prize winners please contact Miss Joan Hicks, 6 rue des Petits Prés, 78810 Feucherolles, Tel 01 30 54 33 06 to arrange a time when you could pick up your prizes from the Legion at 8 rue Boudreau. The limit date for collecting your prize(s) is Friday 13th March. We have to put a time limit on collection due to the move out of rue Boudreau.

We have tried to organise a Club lunch for February but unfortunately we have not been able to find a suitable Restaurant/Café which will charge a reasonable price. Our hard working Social Secretary, Joan Hicks, has come up with a solution for March. One of our members, has kindly offered to host a Buffet Lunch at her home. She can only accommodate 20 people, so first come first served! If you would like to join us please let Joan Hicks know before 23rd February. The cost of the lunch will be €15. This will include an aperitif, wine with lunch and coffee. The date for this lunch is Monday 2nd March, 12h15 for 12h30. The venue is 11 rue François Ponsard, 75116 Paris. Please send your cheque, made payable to The Royal British Legion (in full please do not put RBL) for €15 per person. We hope to find somewhere suitable for April, if anyone knows of a reasonably priced restaurant/café, please let Joan Hicks know on the above telephone number.

As most of you know, we have to send all unclaimed Membership Cards back to London by the end of January. Please if you have not paid your subscription would you send a cheque to either Janet Warby or Mark Yates at 8 rue Boudreau, 75009 Paris. The fee is : Under 65 years of age €46 Over 65 years of age €37 made payable to <u>THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION</u>. If we do not send unclaimed Cards back to London, we the branch have to pay for them; this is something we just cannot afford to do.

All the very best wishes to you all for 2009

Janet Warby *Joan Hicks* *Mark Yates*
Hon Secretary *Social Secretary* *Membership Secretary*

T O M B O L A P R I Z E W I N N E R S

	N A M E	TICKET N°	P R I Z E (NUMBER ON PRIZE)
1	A. Gilbert	4399	Blue padded jacket (13)
2	Gautier Lynham	0836	Satin evening hand bag (12)
3	M-L Jacir	0112	Wall candle (15)
4	J. Sterling	1363	White blouse (8)
5	A. Gilbert	4390	Lady's raincoat (5)
6	B. Ratcliff	2082	Lady's bathrobe (7)
7	Spencer Bernard	0138	White embroidered blouse (19)
8	F. Griffiths	4407	Pink blouse (9)
9	O. Glading	3060	Teddy bear (47)
10	M. Quinlan	2074	Shopping bag (49)
11	Guyenot	4364	"The Christmas Mouse" (40)
12	M. -L. Jacir	4003	"The Fairies of Neverland" (42)
13	J. Aprile	3802	Photograph frame (48)
14	H. A. Peridi	3996	"Queen of Christmas " (41)
15	J. Tucker	2361	Cofee Set (55)
16	M. Quinlan	1064	"Modern Spanish Cooking Book" (52)
17	D. Leck	4260	"Chelsea Football Club Centenary" (54)
18	Herwood	3043	Seaside towel (51)
19	J. Warby	2433	"The Chronicles of Narnia" (53)
20	A. Bouillon	2524	Small decorative horse (57)
21	J. Leck	4258	Small note pad (50)
22	MacGillivray	2579	African bust (58)
23	Vellet	4155	Surprise (56)
24	T. Bennett	3602	Small decorative lacquered box (59)
25	R. Warby	2450	Box of crackers (31)
26	A. Bouillon	2522	Box of crackers (30)
27	Hargrove	1940	Night dress (34)
28	Coulomb-Thibault	2704	Small dish (35)
29	R. Bateau Club	2414	"Alice in Wonderland" (68)
30	J. Tucker	2354	Painting (29)
31	J. Warby	2432	Mince pie (25)
32	T. Bennet	2605	Multiple tea box (16)
33	R. Bateau Club	2414	Set of earthenware goblets (14)
34	Wicker	0166	Multi-grater (17)
35	J. Sterling	1369	Picnic set for four (18)
36	A. Aprile	3791	Bateaux-Mouche tickets (43)
37	N. Riolls	2006	Carpet (6)
38	Renouard	2042	Lady's raincoat (5)
39	A. Newton	2309	5 Day-return ferry crossing (44)
40	D. Handman	3611	"The Polar Express" (39)
41	Griffiths	4408	African handmade candle (67)
42	E. Gould	4440	Small morrocan evening bag (69)
43	Dang/Kinloch	4146	Porcelain kitten (26)
44	D. Leck	3000	Carving board (33)
45	A. Gilbert	4389	Torch (21)

	N A M E	TICKET N°	P R I Z E (NUMBER ON PRIZE)
46	S. Vanula	2292	Small traveling bag (1)
47	J. Tucker	2357	Magnetic note pad (4)
48	A. Choppard	2803	Mauve make-up case (11)
49	L. Clack	1356	Hand-painted porcelain plate (32)
50	Vicky	3076	Norfolkline Dunkerque-Dover : car & 4 passengers (46)
51	L. Clack	1358	Pedometer (2)
52	Bensoussan/Kinloch	4159	Book of contemporary landscapes (65)
53	C. Riols	2014	Photo frame (22)
54	R. Muller	2926	Footstool (62)
55	Dang/Kinloch	4150	6 small ceramic bowls (61)
56	G. Longley	0199	Tea strainer and spiced tea (66)
57	Herwood	3045	“Why I love Christmas” (37)
58	B. Alton	3827	“Snow Globe Family” (38)
59	S. Vanular	2296	“Christmas Carousel” (36)
60	M.-L. Jacir	4004	Pen & holder (63)
61	G. Longley	0200	Weather station (23)
62	O. Glading	3055	Make-up set (24)
63	J. Sterling	1364	Soap set (60)
64	R. Warby	2439	Candle-pen (27)
65	A. Guilbert	4386	Computer mini cleaner (64)
66	R. Cretel	3542	Tea strainer (20)
67	A. Debrosse	2302	Small enamel spoon (28)
68	Vicky	3073	Chronometer (3)
69	T. Sandrine	3461	Surprise (0)
70	L. Roche	0145	P & O Dover-Calais : car & 9 passengers (45)
71	Fewkes	0514	Surprise (73)
72	M. Peron	3972	Bottle of wine (70)
73	Hardgrove	1938	Surprise (74)
74	Guyenot	4365	Surprise (76)
75	Spencer Bernard	0140	Surprise (75)
76	de Saint Jean	0622	Frame (72)
77	C. Thourot	2401	Bottle of champagne (71)
78	R. Bateau Club	2412	Surprise (77)